

The Weird State of Global Snacking

An annual report on how the world grazes · 2024 edition

In 2024 the average person ate roughly 27 kilograms of snacks, a striking 34% increase compared with a decade earlier. Snacking now makes up nearly 22% of total daily calories worldwide.

The reasons behind this shift are cultural as much as economic. As lifestyles grew busier and traditional mealtimes quietly dissolved, people began to graze throughout the day, reaching for convenience over ceremony and comfort over custom.

By volume the category leaders were clear. Chips 4200, Chocolate 3850, Cookies 3100, Popcorn 2400, and Pretzels 1600 units sold per thousand people, with Chips extending its lead for the fifth straight year.

Spending habits split sharply by drink. Coffee drinkers outspent tea drinkers by a wide margin — Coffee 780 versus Tea 410 dollars on snacks per year, the largest gap ever recorded between the two camps.

Global snack revenue climbed relentlessly across the years: 2019 120, 2020 138, 2021 155, 2022 171, 2023 190, and 2024 214 billion dollars, with no sign of the curve flattening.

Appetites varied by country on the global snacking index. USA 92, China 78, Germany 71, India 65, and Brazil 58 points, revealing a surprisingly wide spread across major markets.